

Connected on a long journey

Service Design | UI Design

BRIEF

This project focuses on the families of professional drivers who have been working outside for a long time, aiming to solve the problem of emotional alienation through innovative design. Strengthen the emotional connection and communication experience between drivers and their families through cross temporal interaction.

PURPORT

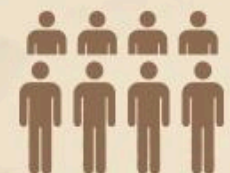
By designing convenient and ritualistic emotional connection tools, we help drivers and their families establish deep interactions across distances. Bring psychological support and a sense of belonging to the family, and enhance the overall happiness index.



Background

Long distance truck drivers are key players in the logistics system, but they also face unique career challenges. Due to the nature of their profession, this group has long been exposed to **high-intensity, high-risk, and isolated work environments**, and their emotional connections with family members are also facing significant challenges.

Data



20 million
registered truck drivers in China



Most of them are Male
Self-employed
30-50 years old



Physical health:

80% of drivers suffer from **chronic diseases** (lumbar spine disease, cervical spondylosis)
70% have **sleep disorders**



Psychological health:

50% of drivers suffer from varying degrees of psychological health problems (anxiety and depression), due to work **pressure and loneliness**



Family relationships:

80% and more of long-distance drivers are unable to meet with their families, and the main contact method is by **phone**

Research

Common difficulties faced by truck drivers



Lack of communication

Long periods of absence from home lead to a lack of shared life experiences between couples, and emotional connections gradually weaken



Lack of emotional expression

Due to fatigue or personality reasons, there is less active expression of emotions, and the marital relationship becomes indifferent



Alienation of parent-child relationship

Drivers who are away for a long time and miss the critical stage of their children's growth may lead to estrangement of parent-child relationship



Emotional agency

Lack of daily companionship and interaction, the interaction between drivers and children appears unfamiliar, and the father's image may have limited impact on the child's growth

Stakeholder Interview

To understand the needs of the core group, first conduct a survey on wives and children



WIFE 1, ZHANG MEI, 42

Although I understand the efforts my husband has made for the family, every time he is not at home, I **feel lonely**, especially during holidays and special moments. I often wish he could be by my side and our children's



WIFE 2, ZHANG MEI, 32

Sometimes I really can't understand why my husband is always so busy. Even though there are many things at home that require his involvement, I feel like he always puts work first and **ignores the needs of his family and children**. Although he says it's for the sake of the family, sometimes I really feel disappointed and helpless



CHILDREN 1, LI JIA, 7

When my dad is not at home, I feel very **sad**. I feel like I only have my mom, and we spend **too little time together**. Every time my mom shows him a video, I can only meet him once. I also envy and feel sad watching other fathers get along with their children.



CHILDREN 2, LI JIA, 8

Whenever my dad is not at home, I feel like **something is missing**, especially on special days. Although my mother works hard to take care of us, sometimes I really wish I could spend these moments with my father instead of facing these important moments alone. Sometimes I don't understand why my dad insists on going out for a sports car.

Interview

TRUCK DRIVER1, WANG GANG

AGE:45 Running a truck for 14 years

I work hard in a demanding and high paying job to support my family and pay for my children's education, but being away from home for a **long time** makes communication difficult. This can lead to **emotional tension**, especially towards my wife and children, but there's nothing I can do about it, after all, I have to make money.

TRUCK DRIVER2, LI PENG

AGE:40 Running a truck for 10 years

I have been racing outside for a long time, which has resulted in very little time to spend with my wife and children. My emotions have gradually become **weaker**, especially with my children. Occasionally, **when I have free time, I also make phone calls and chat**, and I don't know much about the situation at home. Often, I feel very depressed because of these feelings

TRUCK DRIVER3, CHEN LONG

AGE:45 Running a truck for 14 years

My wife takes two children at home, one just started college this year and the other is in high school, which incurs a lot of expenses. Although this job is hard, the income is high. The family needs money and also needs to save for the child's tuition fees. **Being away from home for a long time, my wife worries about many things alone**. She often complains that I only focus on making money and don't care about the family.

Summary

Husband



Pain Points

- Emotional alienation
- Lack of family responsibility
- Emotional loneliness
- My wife's concern that she doesn't understand



Needs

- More family time
- Wife's understanding and support
- Balancing work and family
- Emotional Connection

Wife



Pain Points

- Loneliness and lack of companionship
- I feel that my husband is neglecting the needs of the family
- Confusion about my husband's working hours



Needs

- More companionship from husbands
- Sharing of Family Responsibilities
- Understanding and Support
- Emotional attention and concern

Children



Pain Points

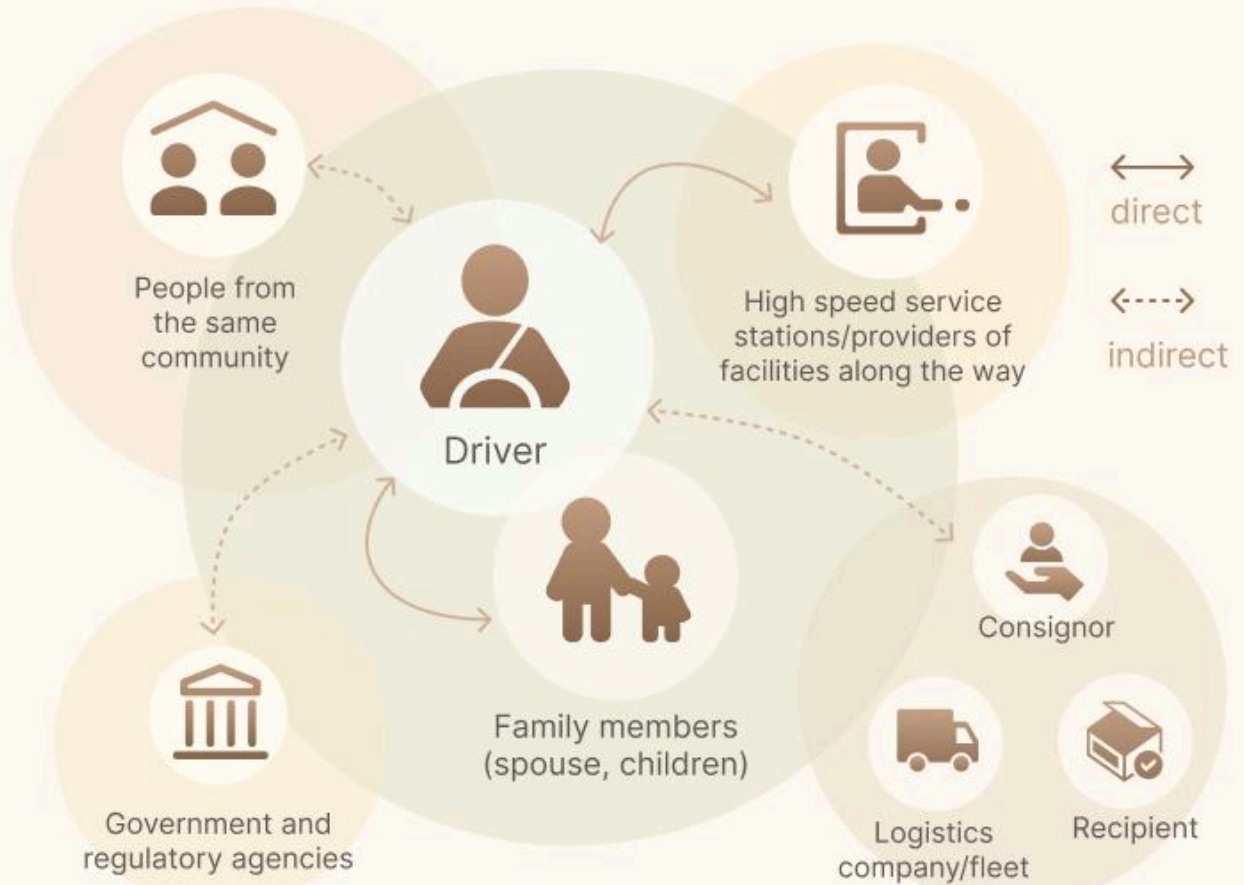
- Lack of father companionship
- Loneliness and envy
- Emotional gap
- I don't understand my father's job choices



Needs

- More time with my father
- Father's companionship and attention
- Understand Father's Work
- I hope my father can balance family and work time

Stakeholder Map



CONCEPT

This is a service that provides a pleasant emotional connection for truck drivers. By designing a ritualistic online and offline emotional connection tool, it enhances the sense of belonging brought by families and improves emotional communication within families.

Target Audience

Husband who sports cars outside for a long time, as well as wife and children who stay at home

Value Direction For Users

- Enhance emotional connections
- Enhance family cohesion
- Relieve separation anxiety
- Promote family growth

Purpose

The purpose of this project is to establish a stable and sustained emotional connection between a husband who works in a sports car for a long time and his wife and children who stay at home.

Solve

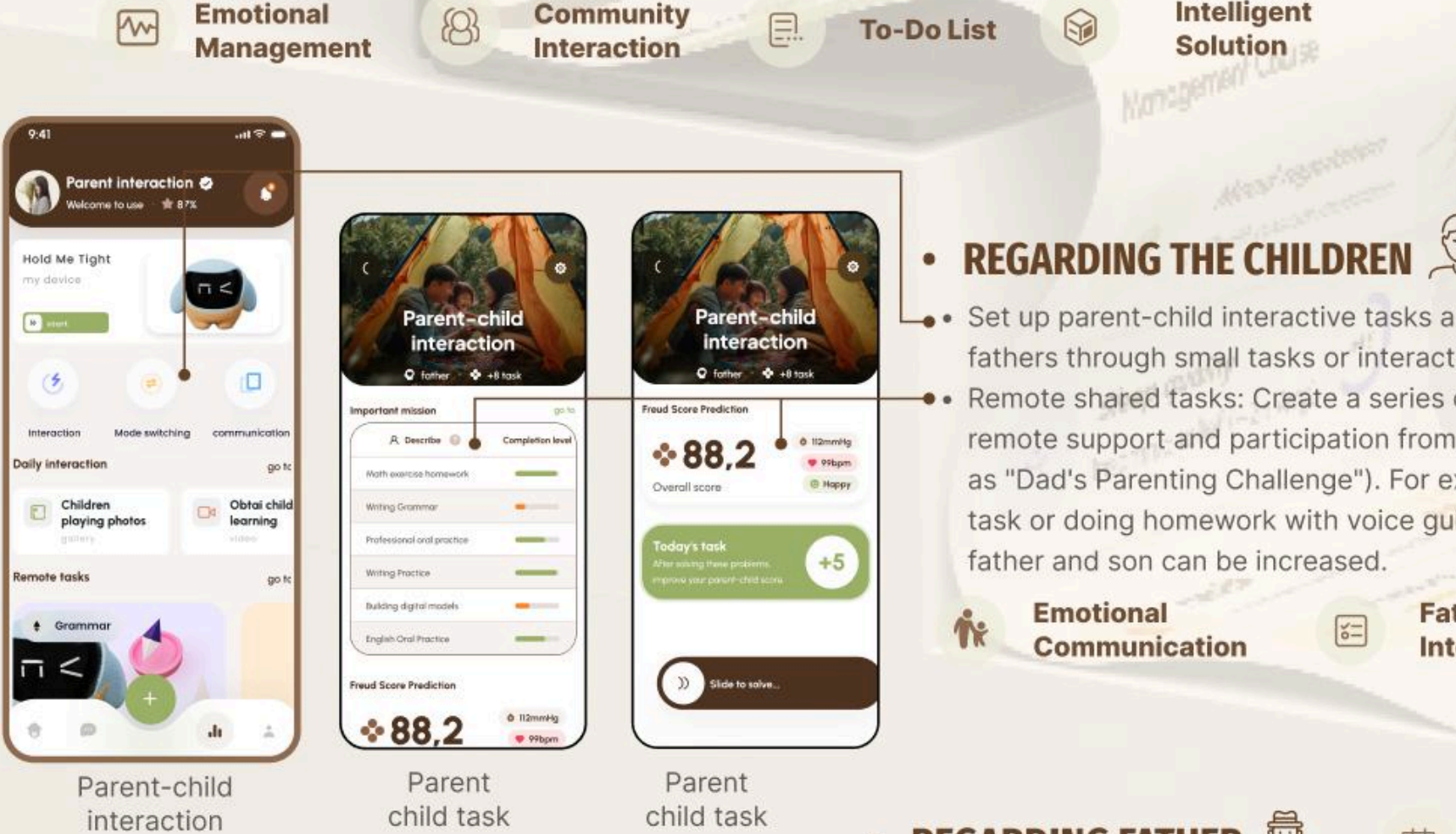
- App
- Workshop

Through innovative online apps and offline workshops, we break the limitations of physical distance, enhance emotional communication, understanding, and interaction among family members, maintain family harmony, and promote personal growth and happiness of family members.

HIGH FIDELITY

REGARDING THE WIFE

- Assist wives in customizing emotional tests to help users understand their own emotional states.
- Emotional support "AI assistant, automatically recommends relevant topics or solutions.
- Anonymous community function, supporting users to post, comment, interact, and organize workshop activities
- Intelligent emotion regulation solution recommendation: Based on diary and map analysis, provide suggestions or psychological courses for users.
- Task List and Management Tool: Provides templates for daily household chores and supports customization. After completing the task, accumulate points and exchange them for virtual rewards (such as virtual medals) or family support suggestions.



REGARDING THE CHILDREN

- Set up parent-child interactive tasks and challenges, encourage children to stay in touch with their fathers through small tasks or interactive games, and promote their emotional communication.
- Remote shared tasks: Create a series of "shared growth tasks" that allow children to receive remote support and participation from their fathers through virtual parent-child interactions (such as "Dad's Parenting Challenge"). For example, by guiding children to complete a small handicraft task or doing homework with voice guidance from the father, the emotional connection between father and son can be increased.

REGARDING FATHER

- Set up "daily tasks" within the app, allowing drivers to feel supported and encouraged by their families through short tasks such as recording their daily feelings and sharing them with their families. They can also see dynamic information posted by their wives and children in the family.
- During the driver's fragmented time, the app will remind them to have video calls with their children and engage in regular simple interactions such as storytelling or remote teaching of a simple task, in order to make up for the long absence of parental love as much as possible.

WORKSHOP

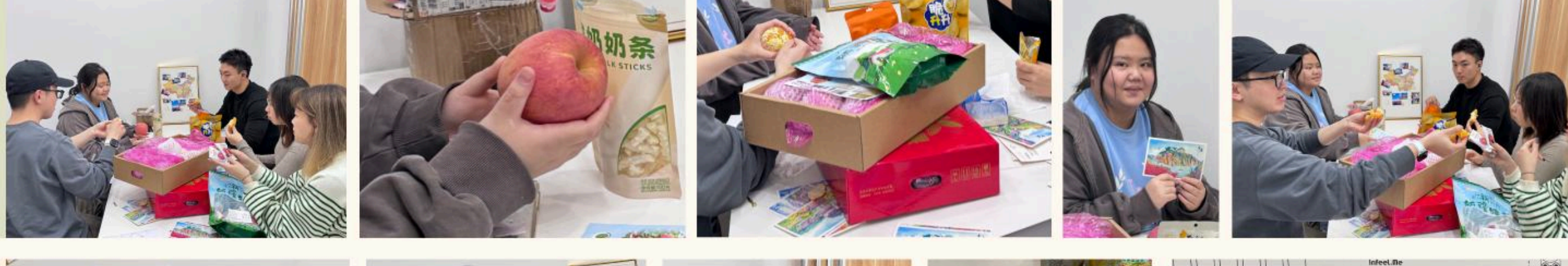
01 Story Sharing Session: Dad's Journey

Show father's moments on transportation route via photos. Set up a "Love Journey Map": Kids take part in interactive activities, mark father's route on the map (like cities the sports car passes through), and use photos or landmarks to mark his experiences, such as where he rested and drove.



02 Specialty Display

Participants will display the specialties brought back by their fathers from different places at the workshop site with a display table. Guide children to share stories about these items, like why the father chose them and the relationship between the specialties and the family (e.g. "Every time my dad comes back from a certain place, he brings this").



03 Interactive Session: Creating Postcards of Love

Provide materials for making handmade gratitude postcards for wives and children. They can write/draw their thoughts, gratitude, or encouragement towards their father on it. Wives can record the information they want to convey, and children can draw pictures related to their fathers. The postcard will be sent to the father through the logistics station or internal company platform



Activity Results



Short - Term Benifites

- Instant emotional satisfaction:** Family members can get chances for emotional communication and interaction via online apps and offline workshops, relieve loneliness and anxiety from long-term separation, and gain instant emotional satisfaction.
- Enhance communication efficiency:** The real-time communication and emotional sharing functions of online apps speed up information transmission and emotional communication among family members, improving efficiency.
- Enhance family atmosphere:** Short-term interactions and activities can quickly boost the family atmosphere, making family members feel mutual love and support.

Long - Term Benifites

- Stable family ties:** Continuous emotional connections deepen trust and understanding among family members, stabilizing relationships and reducing conflicts.
- Promote personal growth:** Family members can enhance emotional expression and social skills by participating in activities and learning communication, thus promoting growth.
- Cultivate family culture:** Long-term project participation forms unique family culture like shared values, traditions and celebration methods, boosting members' sense of belonging and identity.
- Improve family happiness:** Stable relationships, good communication, shared culture and activities significantly enhance family members' happiness, making family their strong support and warm haven.

SERVICE BLUEPRINT

